Op. Dr. Murat Ayata
Kulak Burun Boğaz
Otolaryngology Head and Neck Surgery Specialist

Op. Dr. Murat Ayata Private Clinic
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INFORMED CONSENT FORM

Dermal Filler (Hyaluronic Acid) Treatment

Hyaluronic acid injection for facial volume loss, contour and lines

Dear patient, this form has been prepared to explain, in **plain and clear language**, what you need to know about the procedure recommended to you. Its purpose is not to frighten you, but to help you make your decision **freely and on the basis of good information**.

Please read this form without rushing. Ask your doctor about anything you do not understand. Your doctor will also explain verbally any risks that are particular to your situation. Whether or not you give consent is entirely your right.

PATIENT AND PROCEDURE DETAILS

Full name: _____ Date of birth: _____

Passport / ID No: _____ File / Protocol No: _____

Telephone: _____ Date informed: _____

Planned procedure date: _____

Form first sent to patient (date / e-mail, WhatsApp, in person): _____

Doctor performing the procedure and providing information: **Op. Dr. Murat Ayata**

Place of treatment: _____

Product name / brand: _____

LOT number and expiry date: _____

Total amount (mL): _____

Treatment areas: ☐ Lips ☐ Nasolabial folds ☐ Cheeks / cheekbones ☐ Chin ☐ Jawline ☐ Under-eye (tear trough) ☐ Nose ☐ Other _____

Injection tool: ☐ Needle ☐ Cannula ☐ Both _____

1 Your condition and the aim of the procedure

Hyaluronic acid is a substance found naturally in our skin; it holds water and gives tissues their fullness. Filler products are a laboratory-made, gel form of this substance. They are used to **restore volume** lost with age, to **define the contour** of the lips, cheeks, chin and jawline, or to soften **lines and hollows**.

Volume loss and lines in the face develop because of ageing, changes in bone and fat tissue, weight loss, sun exposure and genetics. The effect of hyaluronic acid filler is **temporary**; it is gradually absorbed by the body. **Permanent filler products are not used in our clinic.**

2 How is the procedure performed?

The treatment is carried out in the clinic. First your face is assessed, your expectations are discussed, a treatment plan is made and photographs are taken before treatment.

1. **Preparation:** Make-up is removed and the skin is cleaned with an antiseptic solution. An anaesthetic cream may be applied for your comfort; most filler products also contain a local anaesthetic (lidocaine).
2. **Injection:** The gel is placed slowly and in small amounts at the planned depth and area, using a fine needle or a flexible blunt-tipped cannula. Safe techniques are used to reduce the risk of injecting into a blood vessel.

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3. **Shaping:** If necessary, the product is gently moulded with the fingers; the result is assessed together with you in the mirror.
4. **Record:** The product name, LOT number, amount and treatment areas are recorded in your file. You may be given a card/label with the product details; we recommend that you keep it.

An important safety advantage of hyaluronic acid filler is that, if necessary, it can be dissolved with an enzyme called **hyaluronidase**. This medicine and emergency equipment are always kept ready in our clinic.

ANAESTHESIA	APPROXIMATE DURATION	HOSPITAL STAY / DISCHARGE
Anaesthetic cream and/or local anaesthetic contained in the product	About 20–45 minutes	Same day; 15–30 minutes of observation afterwards

3 Expected benefits and likelihood of success

- Replacement of lost volume, giving a fresher and more balanced appearance
- More defined and harmonious contours of the lips, cheeks, chin and jawline
- Softening of lines and hollows
- An immediately visible result and a quick return to daily life

The result is visible immediately after treatment and can be judged more clearly once the swelling has settled, at about **2 weeks**. Depending on the product, the area and your metabolism, the effect usually lasts **6–18 months** (shorter in the lips, longer in the cheeks and chin). To maintain the result, treatment needs to be repeated at intervals. Where skin sagging is marked, the improvement achievable with filler may be limited.

4 Other treatment options

- **No treatment:** As this is a cosmetic procedure, you always have the option not to have it.
- **Botulinum toxin:** More suitable for lines caused by facial movement rather than by volume loss.
- **Skin rejuvenation:** Mesotherapy, PRP, peels or laser can improve skin quality but do not add volume.
- **Fat transfer (using your own fat):** May last longer; requires a minor surgical procedure.
- **Surgery:** A face lift, eyelid surgery, chin implant or rhinoplasty may give a more marked or permanent change.

5 What happens if the procedure is not performed?

If the treatment is not carried out, your face will continue to change with natural ageing. This poses no danger to your health.

You have the right to decline the recommended procedure, to postpone it, or to seek a second medical opinion. This decision will not affect any other healthcare offered to you in any way. You may withdraw your consent at any time before the procedure begins; please be aware, however, that once a procedure has started there may be stages at which stopping would be medically unsafe.

6 Preparing for the procedure

- Treatment is **not given, or is postponed,** in the following situations: pregnancy, breastfeeding, active acne, cold sores or infection in the treatment area, known allergy to the product or to lidocaine, a history of severe allergic reactions (anaphylaxis), or an uncontrolled autoimmune disease. Please tell us if any of these apply to you.
- Tell us if you have previously had **any filler** in the same area (especially permanent products or products of unknown type), threads or implants.
- If possible, avoid dental treatment, vaccinations or other planned surgery for **2 weeks before and 2 weeks after** treatment, as these can increase the risk of a delayed inflammatory reaction. If you need them, please let us know.
- If you have an important social event, plan treatment at least 2 weeks beforehand because of possible swelling and bruising.

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- Tell your doctor about **all medicines** you take (including blood thinners, aspirin, painkillers, weight-loss and hormone medicines) and any **herbal products and supplements** (such as omega-3, vitamin E, ginkgo, garlic, ginseng, fish oil). Do not stop any medicine on your own without your doctor's advice.
- Be sure to tell us about any **allergies**, bleeding or clotting problems, heart, lung, diabetes, blood pressure or thyroid conditions, previous operations and any problems you have had with anaesthesia.
- If there is any chance you may be pregnant, or if you are breastfeeding, tell us before the procedure.
- Smoking and nicotine products significantly impair wound healing. If possible, stop at least 2–4 weeks before the procedure and do not smoke during recovery.

7 Recovery: what to expect

First 24 hours	Swelling, tenderness and redness occur in the area; a cold compress helps. Do not massage or press the area. Avoid make-up, saunas, strenuous exercise and alcohol. Swelling is more noticeable after lip filler.
Days 2–7	Swelling largely settles. **If** bruising occurs, it fades within 5–10 days. Small firm areas may be felt; most soften by themselves. Avoid sleeping face down and facial massage.
Week 2	The result settles. A check-up is arranged if needed; if there is asymmetry or under-correction, a small additional treatment may be planned after the doctor's assessment.
Months 6–18	The product is gradually absorbed. The timing of repeat treatment is planned together with you.

8 Possible risks and complications

As with any medical procedure, this procedure carries some risks. Below, **expected temporary effects** and **complications** are listed separately and grouped by how often they occur. The figures given are **approximate** values based on the medical literature; your personal risk may be lower or higher depending on your age, general health, smoking and previous operations.

The great majority of complications are **temporary** and improve with appropriate treatment. Very rare but serious events are also included; being on this list does not mean they will happen to you, but you need to know about them to make an informed decision.

Expected, temporary effects (not complications — a normal part of healing)

- Mild pain, redness and tenderness at the injection points
- Swelling (may be marked for a few days, especially in the lips and under the eyes)
- Bruising; **if** it occurs it fades within 1–2 weeks
- Small firm areas that can be felt (usually soften within a few weeks)

Common conditions (most are temporary or resolve with treatment)

- **Slight asymmetry or more/less fullness than expected** — The two halves of the face are naturally different; small differences may remain. These can be corrected at the check-up with additional filler or with hyaluronidase.
- **Prolonged swelling** — Particularly under the eyes, swelling may last for weeks in some people.

Uncommon conditions

- **Persistent firmness or nodules (lumps)** — May form where product collects in one place. Can be treated with massage, hyaluronidase or other treatments.
- **Bluish discolouration (Tyndall effect)** — May be seen when the product is placed too close to the surface, especially in the thin skin under the eyes; it can be corrected with hyaluronidase.

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- **Movement of the product (migration)** — Over time the product may shift to a neighbouring area (e.g. above the lip border); it can be dissolved if needed.
- **Infection and biofilm** — Rarely, redness, warmth, pain or an abscess may develop at the treatment site. Antibiotics and, if necessary, dissolving the filler and drainage may be needed. If a layer of bacteria (biofilm) forms around the product, inflammation may recur and treatment may take a long time.
- **Delayed inflammatory reaction** — **Weeks or even months** after treatment, often following an immune trigger such as flu, dental treatment or a vaccination, painful swelling and redness may develop in the filler area (in **fewer than 1 in 100** patients). It improves with medication and, if needed, dissolving the filler.
- **Cold sore reactivation** — May occur, especially after lip treatment; if you have had cold sores before, preventive medication may be given.

Rare or very rare, but potentially serious conditions

- **Blockage of a blood vessel (vascular occlusion)** — This is the most important risk of filler. If the product enters a blood vessel or presses on it from outside, the blood supply to that area may be disrupted. It is reported in roughly **1 in 1,000 to 1 in 10,000 treatments**; the risk is higher in the **nose, between the eyebrows and the nasolabial folds**. Signs: **severe pain** during or after treatment, **blanching** of the skin, followed by a **dusky, purplish, net-like discolouration** and coldness. If not recognised early and treated immediately, it can lead to **skin breakdown and tissue loss (necrosis)**, permanent scarring and deformity.
- **Emergency treatment: hyaluronidase** — If a vascular occlusion is suspected, the treatment is stopped at once and a high dose of **hyaluronidase** is injected to dissolve the filler, together with warm compresses, massage and medication. This treatment is usually effective but **may not always fully reverse** the damage. Hyaluronidase itself can very rarely cause an allergic reaction. Hospital referral, wound care, prolonged treatment or later corrective procedures may be required.
- **Loss of vision and stroke** — Although extremely rare, if the product reaches the blood vessels supplying the eye or brain it can cause **partial or complete, permanent loss of vision** or a **stroke**. It is most often associated with treatment of the nose and the area between the eyebrows. In this situation **minutes matter**; you will be referred to hospital for emergency eye and neurological assessment.
- **Serious allergic reaction** — A severe allergic reaction (anaphylaxis) to hyaluronic acid or lidocaine is extremely rare; it requires emergency treatment.
- **Granuloma** — The body forms firm, inflammatory lumps in reaction to the product; this is very rare and may need long-term treatment.

General risks that apply to any surgical / medical procedure

- **Feeling faint (vasovagal reaction):** Dizziness, sweating and brief fainting may occur during an injection or blood draw; it passes quickly if you lie down.
- **Infection:** With skin disinfection and sterile materials the risk is very low; if it occurs it is usually treated with antibiotics.
- **Allergic reaction:** To the product, local anaesthetic or antiseptic used — ranging from mild redness to, very rarely, a severe allergic reaction (anaphylaxis). Our clinic is equipped with emergency equipment and medicines.
- **Cold sore (herpes) reactivation:** If you have had cold sores before, they may reappear in the treated area; please let us know.
- **Result not meeting expectations:** The degree and duration of the effect vary between individuals; additional sessions or touch-up treatment may be needed.

This list does not include every possible complication; other unforeseeable and very rare events may occur. If a complication develops, your doctor will plan the necessary treatment and follow-up; this may require additional treatment, medication, procedures or a further operation.

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9 When to contact us immediately

- **Severe pain** after treatment that does not settle or keeps increasing
- **Blanching, or a dusky purplish, net-like (marbled) discolouration** of the skin, coldness, blisters or a wound
- **Blurred vision or loss of vision**, eye pain or double vision — **minutes matter**: call immediately or go to the nearest emergency department
- Sudden **severe headache, slurred speech, weakness of the face, arm or leg** (signs of stroke) — call 112 immediately
- Rapidly developing swelling of the face, lips or tongue, hives or shortness of breath
- Fever, redness, warmth and increasing firmness/swelling (even weeks later)

If any of these occur, call your doctor without delay: +90 288 502 50 20 · WhatsApp +90 555 333 21 20. If you cannot reach us, go to the nearest emergency department or call 112 (the emergency number in Türkiye and across Europe).

10 Medication and everyday-life advice

- Avoid make-up, saunas, Turkish baths, strenuous exercise and alcohol for the first 24 hours; avoid massaging the area, facials and sleeping face down for the first 2 weeks.
- Protect the area from sun, sunbeds and very cold conditions for the first 2 weeks.
- If another doctor treats your face in the future (filler, laser, surgery, dental treatment), tell them you have had filler and the name of the product.
- Take the medicines prescribed for you (antibiotics, painkillers, etc.) at the recommended dose and for the recommended time. Do not take aspirin or similar medicines that may increase bleeding without asking your doctor.
- On flights or journeys longer than 4 hours after surgery, drink plenty of water, move around regularly and wear compression stockings if advised; this reduces the risk of leg clots.
- During recovery you are advised not to drink alcohol and to avoid smoking and nicotine products.
- Please attend all follow-up appointments. If you have travelled from abroad, follow-up after your return can continue by online consultation and photos/videos; if you need to see a local doctor, you will be given a written operation report and our recommendations.

11 Photographs, image records and your personal data

Photographs/videos may be taken before and after the procedure for planning, follow-up and assessment of the result. These records form part of your medical file and are kept confidential. Your images will **never be used for advertising, promotion or social media.**

Your images may be used for any other purpose **only with your separate and explicit permission**. Declining will not affect your treatment in any way, and you may withdraw your permission at any time:

☐ I agree that my images are used **only for medical records and treatment follow-up**.

☐ I permit my images to be used for scientific publication and medical education **in a way that does not identify me** (face/eye area covered).

☐ I permit my images to be used for scientific publication and medical education **in a way that may identify me**.

☐ I **do not permit** scientific/educational use.

Your personal and health data are processed under the Turkish Personal Data Protection Law No. 6698 (KVKK) and the relevant health legislation, for the purposes of diagnosis, treatment and legal obligations, by persons bound by professional confidentiality. You may consult our Data Protection Information Notice for details.

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12 Information and notes specific to you (completed by the doctor)

Patient-specific additional risks (co-existing diseases, medicines, previous operations), details of the plan, the patient's expectations, questions asked and answers given. If there is nothing to add, write "none".

13 Patient declaration

- ☐ I have read and understood this form in my own language. I was given enough time to think; I had the opportunity to ask questions and received satisfactory answers.
- ☐ My condition, the aim of the recommended procedure, how it will be done, by whom and where, its approximate duration, expected benefits, likelihood of success, alternatives and what may happen if it is not done have been explained to me verbally and in writing.
- ☐ The common and potentially serious risks, and the possible consequences of these complications (including that further treatment or a repeat procedure/operation may be needed), have been explained to me. I understand that the outcome of any medical procedure **cannot be 100% guaranteed**.
- ☐ I have given accurate and complete information about my health, the medicines I take, my allergies and past illnesses. I understand that incomplete or incorrect information may increase the risks.
- ☐ I understand that following the instructions given before and after the procedure plays a part in the result, and that attending follow-up appointments is important.
- ☐ I know that I can withdraw my consent at any time before the procedure begins. I understand that signing this form does not remove the doctor's duty of care.
- ☐ I am making this decision of my own free will, without pressure from anyone.
- ☐ It has been explained to me that there is a risk of vascular occlusion and resulting skin damage and, although very rarely, of loss of vision and stroke; what emergency treatment (hyaluronidase) would be given in that case; and that this treatment may not always be fully successful.
- ☐ I understand that the effect of filler is temporary and that permanent fillers are not used in this clinic, and I declare that I have fully disclosed any previous filler or implant treatments.
- ☐ I understand that this procedure is **cosmetic**, that it is not medically necessary and that I always have the option not to have it. I have discussed my expectations with my doctor, and the realistic result that can be achieved has been explained to me.
- ☐ I understand that perfect symmetry or an exact copy of the appearance in a photograph cannot be guaranteed, that the final result depends on how my tissues heal, and that in some cases a correction procedure may be needed.

- ☐ **I GIVE MY CONSENT to the procedure described above.**
- ☐ **I DO NOT ACCEPT the procedure described above. The possible consequences of refusing have been explained to me.**

We recommend the patient writes in their own handwriting: "I have read and understood this form and I give my consent."

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14 Signatures

	FULL NAME	SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
Patient			
Legal representative (parent / guardian) — relationship:			
Doctor providing information and performing the procedure			
Interpreter (if needed) — language:			
Witness (if needed)			

Interpreter's statement: I have translated this form and the doctor's verbal explanations to the patient / legal representative completely and accurately, in a language they understand.

FOR PATIENTS UNDER 18 OR WITH LIMITED DECISION-MAKING CAPACITY

For patients under 18, consent is given by a **parent or legal guardian**. The child is informed in a way appropriate to their age and maturity and their view is sought. For patients lacking capacity, consent is given by the legal representative.

☐ If we share parental responsibility, I declare that the other parent is aware of and agrees to this procedure.

☐ I declare that there is no court order or dispute concerning custody / guardianship (if there is, the relevant document has been shown to the doctor).

The child was informed in an age-appropriate way; the child's view: _____

This form has been prepared in two copies: one is kept in the patient's file and one is given to the patient / legal representative.

WITHDRAWAL OF CONSENT (COMPLETE ONLY IF YOU CHANGE YOUR MIND)

I withdraw the consent I gave above. The possible consequences of withdrawing have been explained to me.

Name, signature, date and time of patient/representative withdrawing consent: _____

This form has been prepared in accordance with the Turkish Patient Rights Regulation and the informed consent principles of the Turkish Medical Association. It complements, but does not replace, the verbal explanation given by your doctor.